

tmux documentation

Scrolling terminal output in tmx

This build is configured so you can scroll back through terminal output **from any device** — a desktop mouse, a laptop trackpad, or a phone (Termux on Android) — and it works the same inside full-screen TUIs such as the Claude Code TUI.

All of this is set up automatically by `bash scripts/setup.sh`. The settings live in [scripts/tmux.conf.template](#), which the `tmx` wrapper loads on every `tmx new`.

What you get

Setting	Value	Why
<code>history-limit</code>	50000 lines	Output history survives — you can scroll a long way back.
<code>mode-keys</code>	<code>vi</code>	vi-style navigation in copy-mode.
<code>mouse</code>	<code>on</code>	Wheel + touch scrolling.
<code>WheelUpPane / WheelDownPane</code>	<code>copy-mode override</code>	The wheel always scrolls tmux's own buffer — even inside Claude Code.
<code>allow-passthrough</code>	<code>on</code>	Apps can pass escape sequences through tmux.
<code>extended-keys</code>	<code>on</code>	Modified keys (e.g. <code>Shift+Enter</code>) reach the app.

The Claude Code TUI fix

The Claude Code TUI requests mouse reporting from the terminal. With tmux's *default* wheel binding, that means the wheel is forwarded to Claude Code instead of scrolling tmux's scrollbar — so you cannot scroll back through earlier output.

This build overrides `WheelUpPane / WheelDownPane` so the wheel (and a touch-scroll, which terminals deliver as wheel events) **always** drives tmux copy-mode scrollbar. You scroll the real output history regardless of what the running application does with the mouse.

How to scroll

With a mouse or trackpad

- **Scroll up** — wheel up. tmux enters copy-mode and scrolls back.
- **Scroll down** — wheel down. When you reach the bottom, copy-mode exits automatically.

Without a mouse — keyboard (and phones)

- `Ctrl-b` then `[` — enter copy-mode.
- `Ctrl-b` then `PageUp` — enter copy-mode **and** page up in one motion.

- In copy-mode: `k/j` line up/down, `Ctrl-u/Ctrl-d` half-page, `PageUp/PageDown`, `g/G` top/bottom, `/` search forward, `?` search back, `q` to exit.

On a phone (Termux / Android)

- **Touch-scroll** the terminal — Termux delivers the swipe as wheel events, so it enters copy-mode and scrolls, exactly like a mouse.
- The `Ctrl-b` [route also works using Termux's extra-keys row (enable it with a long-press on the keyboard area if hidden).

Copying text

In copy-mode: press `v` to start a selection, move the cursor, then press `y` or `Enter` to copy. A mouse drag also selects and copies on release.

The selection is routed to your system clipboard automatically — the config detects `pbcopy` (macOS), `wl-copy` (Wayland), `xclip` (X11), or `termux-clipboard-set` (Termux) at copy time, and also emits OSC-52 so copying works over SSH and on terminals that support it.

Verifying it works

The behaviour is covered by `scripts/tests/17_scrollback_copy_mode.sh`, which runs as part of the verification gate. It spawns a real session via `tmx new`, generates 3000 lines of output, proves the first line scrolled off the visible screen, then proves copy-mode can scroll back to it and copy it — all with captured runtime evidence per the anti-bluff covenant.

```
bash scripts/tests/17_scrollback_copy_mode.sh
# → PASS=13  FAIL=0  SKIP=0
```

Re-applying after a config change

`scripts/tmux.conf.template` is the single source. After editing it (or pulling an update), re-run `bash scripts/setup.sh` — or, in a running session, `tmx` picks up the template on the next `tmx new`. To reload into an already-running session: `Ctrl-b` then `:source-file ~/.tmux.conf`.